> *There is no concept of citizenship in Pakistan. The common man is helpless. He is not given basic rights. He is ridiculed and insulted. He is caught unawares by a stray bullet. He is a victim of the numerous bomb blasts and no one can save him.*
>
> (Madrassa Student, Male, Islamabad)

The state in Pakistan has failed to develop a clear understanding of the legal side of citizenship relating to rights, duties and political participation. This failure is compounded by issues of unemployment and poverty on the one hand, and violence and destruction on the other, depending on where the Pakistani citizen is located. For instance, the male madrassa student living in Islamabad quoted above is originally from a town in KP, and his experience of citizenship and the Pakistani state is informed by his lived realities in KP. There are degrees of state failure in the lives of Pakistanis, as narrated by participants in this book, depending on their locations, which range from the Hazaras in Quetta to the Pushtuns in Peshawar or the young people from the Muhajir community in Karachi. These failures fluctuate across class, ethnic and religious markers; gender is also an important indicator. A strong legal definition of citizenship could not have been developed during the thirty-odd years of military rule, during which issues of citizens' rights were put on the back burner and political participation was restricted. However, Pakistan has also had almost forty years of civilian leadership. In the most recent decade of civilian rule (2008 to the present) Pakistan has demonstrated slow progress in the World Economic Forum's Global Competitiveness Index (GCI)[12] as shown in Table 1.1 but continues to face challenges (see Table 1.2). It is still among the worst-performing nations on the index (World Economic Forum 2017–18) at 3.67 between Uganda (3.7) and Cameroon (3.65).

The key performance-determining factors for developing economies such as Pakistan's are the basic requirements which consist of four main pillars: institutions, infrastructure, macroeconomic stability and health and primary

Table 1.1 Global Competitiveness Index Rankings (2017–18)

Edition	**2012–13**	**2013–14**	**2014–15**	**2015–16**	**2016–17**	**2017–18**
Rank	124/144	133/148	129/144	126/140	122/138	115/137
Score	3.5	3.4	3.4	3.4	3.5	3.7

Note: https://www.weforum.org/reports/the-global-competitiveness-report-2017-2018

Source: p. 230.